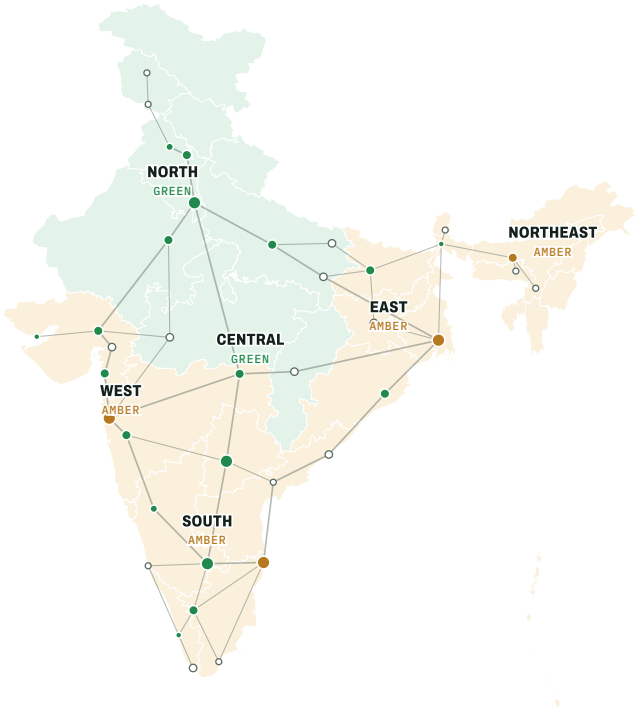
INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 018 SATURDAY 24 OCTOBER 2026 · 09:00 IST

# Instamart's orders fill its stores, and a cyclone nears Kakinada

NETWORK: AMBER

Swiggy opened 69 more Instamart stores before the sale because its busiest ones were full, and each now takes about 1,200 orders a day. IMD expects a cyclonic storm by Monday, reaching the north Andhra and south Odisha coast on Wednesday morning. Brent is near $115, and Kandla still has 71 ships waiting despite record days.

## HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?




Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

## DATES TO WATCH

| | |
|---|---|
| Sat 24 Oct | Kolkata immersion bans on goods vehicles |
| Sat 24 Oct | Bay low becomes a depression |
| 24–27 Oct | IndiGo's Jeddah, Dammam, Madinah flights off |
| 24–31 Oct | IndiGo's Riyadh flights off |
| Sun 25 Oct | Petrapole–Benapole reopens to cargo |
| Mon 26 Oct | Cyclonic storm likely over the Bay |
| Mon 26 Oct | Karnataka cane price meeting in Belagavi |
| 26–27 Oct | Kolkata immersion bans, second round |
| 26 Oct–5 Nov | NH-10 night closures |
| Wed 28 Oct | Storm near north Andhra–south Odisha coast |
| Sun 1 Nov | Delhi keeps out non-BS-VI vehicles from outside |
| Sun 1 Nov | CMA CGM's new North Europe–India rates |
| Sun 1 Nov | Ethanol year starts without sugar-based ethanol |

GREEN the sale season as usual, which can still be busy

AMBER something beyond the season is slowing freight

RED something is stopping freight across a state or a route

### North

GREEN

The north's freight runs as the season does, busy with Diwali stock but with no delay beyond the season into Delhi, Lucknow or Amritsar.

### West

AMBER

JNPA's import boxes waiting for inland trains fell by a fifth on Friday, to 3,087 TEU from 3,901, and the freight-station pile eased to 11,608[1,2]. In Sangli, someone set fire to a tractor taking cane to the Krishna mill early Friday, as Swabhimani's activists try to stop cane moving before a price is set, ChiniMandi reports[3]. I'd expect Nhava Sheva's inland boxes to run a day late through the weekend and catch up by Wednesday, and Sangli's mills to crush below plan this week.

### South

AMBER

Tamil Nadu's heavy rain spell runs to the 27th, and The Week reports waterlogging in Chennai and flooded homes in Kanyakumari, Tenkasi and Madurai[4]. Mandya's cane growers held the Bengaluru–Mysuru highway at Ganangur for about two hours on Friday, Urban Acres reports, and wait on Monday's meeting in Belagavi[5]. I'd expect Chennai and Madurai deliveries to slip a day till Tuesday, and Mysuru's loads to lose a few hours again if Monday's meeting brings no price.

### East

AMBER

Kolkata Police keep trucks out again tonight for the immersions, then bar them for two more nights from Monday[6]. Petrapole reopens to Bangladesh cargo tomorrow after the Puja halt[7]. I'd expect export trucks to queue at the border through Monday, and Kolkata's held parcels to reach doorsteps from Sunday before slipping again on Wednesday.

### Northeast

AMBER

Graphite India's Durgapur plant has lost output and stopped exports, with over 1,000 workers idle, while about 300 coke trucks from Assam stay held at the Srirampur border for a 40th day, Sanmarg reports[8]. Sixteen carry coke for Rain CII Carbon in Visakhapatnam, India Shipping News reports, and no authority has said why they are held[9]. I'd expect the carbon plants in Durgapur and Visakhapatnam to run short into November unless the trucks move this week.

### Central

GREEN

Central India's freight runs as the season does, with no delay beyond the season into Nagpur, Indore or Raipur.

NETWORK INSIGHTS

## 1 Swiggy adds 69 Instamart stores because its busiest ones are full

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Swiggy opened a net 69 Instamart dark stores from July to September, to 1,240 in 133 cities, because more stores were reaching full use, Logistics Insider reports from its results[10]. Each store handled 1,192 orders a day, up 9.5% on the quarter, and orders rose 29% on last year to 130 million[10]. That was before a single festive sale day, mind you. This week, searches for Blue Dart's customer care doubled after Dussehra and Delhivery's rose by half[11]. So what gives first? The store, not the van. I'd expect the fullest dark stores in the metros to run out of shelf before Diwali on 8 November, and to need two restocks a day in its last week.

> **Quick commerce platforms hit their ceiling inside the store this Diwali, because a full store can't take festival lines without dropping others. Brands selling through them may get less shelf in the metros, and stock that doesn't fit waits in the warehouse. Carriers and 3PLs restocking dark stores face more, smaller runs each day into early November.**

## 2 IMD expects a cyclone on Monday, near Kakinada and south Odisha by Wednesday

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Cargo handled at Paradip on 22 October, this year and last (Paradip Port daily report)




IMD now expects a cyclonic storm by Monday morning, reaching the north Andhra and south Odisha coast around Wednesday morning, Sambad English reports, which would delay that coast's cargo midweek[12]. Odisha TV, from the same IMD briefing, puts winds at 70 to 80 kmph gusting to 90 by Monday, with a red rain warning for Ganjam, Gajapati, Rayagada, Koraput and Malkangiri on the 28th[13]. Where exactly? Two weather models put landfall on the Kakinada–Visakhapatnam stretch on Wednesday afternoon, though IMD's own forecast names only the coast[12]. Paradip goes in running hot, with 485,000 tonnes handled on the 22nd against 290,000 a year earlier[14]. I'd expect Visakhapatnam and Kakinada to stop berthing from Tuesday night to Thursday, trucks on NH-16 between Kakinada and Srikakulam to stand on Wednesday, and Paradip's heavy run to pause for a day.

> **Manufacturers and exporters with boxes or bulk booked through Visakhapatnam or Kakinada on 27–29 October risk a rolled vessel and a week's wait for the next one. Brands selling online and carriers with Diwali stock on NH-16 between Chennai and Kolkata lose a day on every truck caught south of Srikakulam.**

## 3 Shipping crude costs $20 a barrel, up from $3, as Brent nears $115

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Goldman Sachs puts the average cost of shipping crude above $20 a barrel, from $3 a year ago, with Hormuz war risk about a third of it, India Shipping News reports[15]. Brent stood near $115 on Friday morning after Houthi militants claimed a strike on Saudi Arabia's Yanbu port, DNA reports[16], and Iran's IRGC says it set four oil ships ablaze in the Gulf this week[17]. HPCL now buys almost all its Gulf crude delivered, to keep its own ships out of harm's way, and says its tanker freight doubled last quarter[18]. Will diesel follow? DNA notes the oil companies have raised diesel several times in recent months and says more rises can't be ruled out[16]. I'd expect another diesel rise before Diwali if Brent holds above $110, reaching truck freight across India within a week.

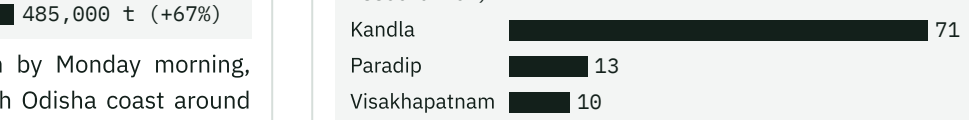
> **Carriers and 3PLs on fixed-rate contracts take the first hit from any diesel rise, a cost they can't pass on until their rates reset. Manufacturers and exporters pay it next as fuel surcharges, and brands selling online when delivery rates are reset after the sale.**

## 4 Kandla handles a million tonnes a day four times this month, and 71 ships still wait

Kandla's anchorage → bulk importers and exporters in Gujarat and the north

● AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Ships waiting at anchor, 21 October (Indian Ports Association)




Kandla handled 1.096 million tonnes on 21 October, its fourth day over a million tonnes this month, India Shipping News reports, yet 71 ships still wait at anchor[19,20]. That is the longest line at any major port, against Paradip's 13 and Visakhapatnam's 10, in the Indian Ports Association's count the same day[20]. So is Kandla slow? Turns out it is full. A port working at record pace with an unchanged queue is taking cargo in as fast as it clears it. More room is coming, of course, just not this season: Kandla awarded Essar Ports an 18.33 million tonne terminal at Tuna Tekra on the 21st, due to open by 2031[21]. I'd expect the line to stay near 70 ships into November, so a ship joining it this week berths next month.

> **Manufacturers and exporters moving bulk or bagged cargo through Kandla pay demurrage for every day at anchor, and their buyers abroad get later arrivals. Carriers and 3PLs trucking to the port face tight gate slots while the berths stay full.**

## THE LANES I'M WATCHING

### NH-85 Adimali–Munnar

● AMBER

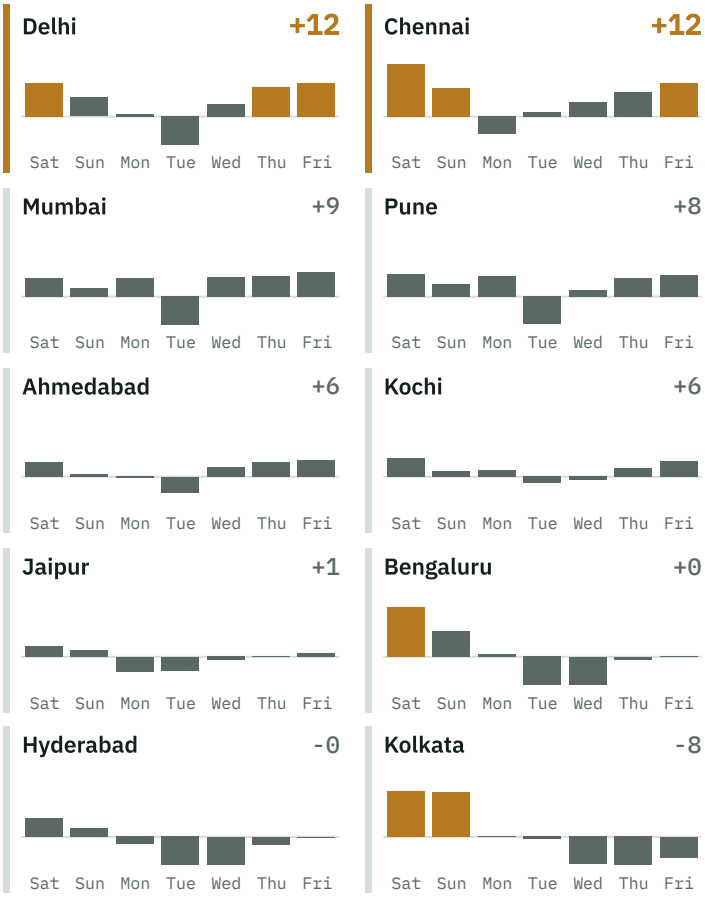
PART-OPEN AFTER A LANDSLIDE AT KALLAR

Soil and rock came down on the highway at Kallar after Friday afternoon's rain, police sent vehicles round by other roads, and traffic was moving only partly while the debris was cleared, PTI reports[22]. With IMD's orange alerts on Kerala to the 25th, I'd expect loads for Munnar and its estates to run half a day late through Sunday.

## CITY TRAFFIC UPDATES

City roads against usual, daily, 17–23 Oct[23] amber = 10+ over

Chennai ran high through the rain, with waterlogging on its roads on Friday[4]. Delhi's lift on Thursday and Friday came with the Old RTR flyover's airport-side carriageway shut for crack repairs until the 25th[24]. Kolkata's early-week lift came under the Puja road closures[6], and Bengaluru's as Dasara holiday traffic headed out of town[25].




## HOW MY CALLS HAVE DONE

Of the 5 calls scored so far, 4 came true, 1 partly and none was wrong. 4 are still open. From 12 Oct:

1. The state retailers hold diesel prices through 19th October, while Jio-bp's and Nayara's stay ₹3 a litre higher. **Right.** No change reported at the state pumps; Nayara and Jio-bp charge ₹3 more. Source
2. Delhi's BS-IV exemption has not been extended by 19th October. **Right.** Gurugram police confirmed the 1 November cut-off on the 16th. Source

## HOW THIS IS MADE

At 7 every morning, Claude drafts this page on its own using data available from public sources only. It reads the morning's public signals: city traffic in ten cities, the JNPA and Paradip port reports, ship queues at the container ports, toll-plaza truck counts, the seasonal calendar and about twenty news searches.

Then it writes, and a set of checks decides whether the draft is even fit for me to read. Every claim has to be opened and cited, and no source can be over a week old without a reason. No story from the last seven days comes back unless it actually moved, and nothing gets said twice.

I read it, argue with it, fix what's wrong and approve it. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. Does that make the page right? Not always, which is why the calls get scored.

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## SOURCES

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